

1. Quoting Ben Affleck

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-07T23:14:58+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/7/ben-affleck/>

I've always been kind of into computers since I was young. And then when film started to move from analog film to digital, I became more interested in that aspect of it. And the visual effects workflow for many years has included machine learning. So I can write like pretty shitty Python scripts and stuff like that because with convolutional neural networks, which were the sort of precursors to what the transformer can do, which is just much more computation simultaneously, you would do things like look at what's called a tensor, which is just the numerical translation of a visual image in numbers ? like the batch number, the frame number, the red, green, and blue values of each pixel in each frame. And a tensor, you use a convolutional neural network to identify patterns in that that would reveal what's called edge detection or feature extraction, which is just identifying patterns enough to know like this is where the window ledge is, so we can more easily take the green screen image out and replace it with something. ? Ben Affleck , Pythonista Tags: machine-learning , python

2. Claude Haiku 5.5

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-07T20:56:21+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/7/claude-haiku-5-5/>

As previously promised , here's Anthropic's new fast, low cost model: Introducing Claude Haiku 5.5 . The previous Haiku, 4.5, was very much showing its age. It came out almost a year ago , and was priced at \$1/million input and \$5/million output - relatively expensive even back then, and a full 10x the price of OpenAI's GPT-6 Luna , released last month. The new Haiku exactly matches the price of GPT-6 Luna - \$0.10/\$0.50 - up to 100,000 tokens. Beyond 100,000 tokens the price increases 5x to \$0.50/\$2.50. Luna itself has a price increase at 272,000 tokens but only to \$0.20/\$0.75. Haiku 5.5 also uses a new, less generous tokenizer. My Claude Token Counter tool shows that the same long prompt uses around 1.25x as many tokens with Haiku 5.5 compared to Haiku 4.5, so there's a hidden price increase there. If your workloads fit in 100,000 tokens, Haiku is the same price as Luna and reports higher benchmark scores. Above 100,000 tokens, Luna looks like a much better deal. The most recent release of llm-anthropic finally fixed it so I don't need to ship a new version of that plugin for every new model. I tested the new model like this: llm install -U llm-anthropic llm anthropic refresh llm...

3. Anti-Patterns in Software Blogging

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-07T14:53:51+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/7/anti-patterns-in-software-blogging/>

Anti-Patterns in Software Blogging Some excellent writing advice from Michael Lynch. Michael warns against "meandering intros", misjudging your reader's existing knowledge, assuming they'll read your previous posts, and excessive formality. He also warns against overreliance on links as an excuse not to explain terminology. This one hurt! I do this all the time, but I have a nagging suspicion that almost nobody ever clicks on them. (In a Lobste.rs comment Michael clarifies that "My rule of thumb is that my article should still make sense to the reader even if they don't click any links". That works for me.) This point about using your own voice is crucial: Beginner software bloggers suffer from a mass delusion that you have to write in a stiff, overly formal way for people to take you seriously [...] Just write the way you talk. With so many developers delegating their writing to AI, software blogging is becoming bland and homogenous. Readers are hungry for writing with personality. Via Lobste.rs Tags: blogging , writing , michael-lynch

4. Jaguar Type 01

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-07T23:22:28Z

Link: <https://insideevs.com/news/810839/jaguar-type-01-launch-ev/>

This is a cool car. It doesn't look like anything else and it looks like it's been pulled a few years from the future. I don't know about this whole trend where cars don't have rear windows though. I get it that you just use the camera but my old habits says I want to see out the back sometimes. But the only reason I wouldn't buy this thing is that turd of a new logo Jaguar went with. I could not abide driving around in something with this typographic calamity . ?

5. Gurman Strikes Again: Apple's Smart Home Push Includes Doorbell, Lock, Thermostat Codeveloped With LG?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-07T22:02:43Z

Link: <https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-10-06/apple-s-smart-home-push-includes-doorbell-lock-thermostat-codeveloped-with-lg?accessToken=eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJzbnV5Y2UiOiJTdWJzY3JpYmVyR2lmdGVkQXJ0aWNsZSIsImIhdCI6MTc5MTMyMDkxNiwiZXhwIjoxNzE2LCJhcnR5Ij0iLSk9JlYXPFHac9EpcJCERtgJNAwqmpV6qFoORcKffVo>

The incomparable Mark Gurman, reporting for Bloomberg: Apple Inc.'s upcoming push into smart home devices will include a doorbell, thermostat and other accessories developed through an unusual partnership with LG Electronics Inc. The products will be part of an ecosystem of devices that work with Apple's new smart home hub, as well as an upgraded HomePod mini and fresh TV set-top box, according to people with knowledge of the matter. The new Apple devices are set to be introduced on Oct. 13. The products developed with South Korea's LG will also include a smart deadbolt lock, indoor security camera, outdoor security camera and floodlight camera, said the people, who asked not to be identified because the undertaking is private.

Though the two companies worked together to develop the accessories, the products will carry the LG brand. The South Korean firm is handling manufacturing and product support. Gurman has more than "people familiar with the matter" (or Matter, for that matter) ? he cites FCC filings from LG that have product names and illustrations of some of the devices' rear panels (with the connectors). As Gurman himself notes, this is somewhat unusual for Apple, but it's...

6. Muse Looks Cute, but Looks Are Deceiving

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-25T16:38:39Z

Link: <https://www.inc.com/jason-aten/meta-keeps-apologizing-for-muse-its-explanations-miss-the-point-entirely/91409363>

Jason Aten, in a good follow-up to his previous column at Inc. (the one where he described how Muse, running on his Mac, read his Messages database): The entire reason Muse is interesting is that it isn't just a chatbot, but can actually do things for you. But that promise also comes with a pretty high bar of responsibility. If your goal is to put a powerful AI agent on millions of devices, you have to be incredibly clear about what's happening, and what people are agreeing to. If your primary audience does not understand what Full Disk Access means, you should not surprise them with "I'm reading your text messages." It's unreasonable to expect them to learn about things like virtual machines, permission architectures, macOS TCC, Sentinel agents, or database synchronization in order to understand what the thing is doing or what is happening with their personal information. Having an agent installed on people's computers that appears overeager to access their information or take action on their behalf isn't helpful. It's terrifying. Aten makes some good points about the inherent tension between Muse ? especially in the context of running on your Mac desktop ? being powerful cuttin...

7. ShinyHunters Extorted Boeing Spin-off Prior to Arrests

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 13:48:45 +0000

Link:

<https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/10/shinyhunters-extorted-boeing-spin-off-prior-to-arrests/>

A teenager from Amman, Jordan suspected of leading the prolific data theft and extortion group ShinyHunters has been detained and is reportedly cooperating with the FBI to identify other members of the hacking gang. KrebsOnSecurity has learned that the suspect, who uses the hacker handle "Rey," was detained as ShinyHunters was in the process of extorting a business unit recently divested by the global aerospace company Boeing, which manufactures the fleet of

planes used by the employer of Rey's father -- Royal Jordanian Airlines.

8. How can undefined opcodes ud0 and ud1 have parameters? How undefined were they?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261007-00/?p=112759/>

They weren't defined, not even as undefined. The post How can undefined opcodes ud0 and ud1 have parameters? How undefined were they? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Pluralistic: Disloyalty (07 Oct 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 13:58:46 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/07/gouged/>

Today's links Disloyalty: Air Canada's frequent flier fuckery. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Indie booksellers v internet; Coke pays dieticians to astroturf soda taxes; Voting in a voter-suppression state; Facebook v your use of Facebook. Upcoming appearances: Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Paris, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenny, Sheffield, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Disloyalty (permalink) Up until very recently indeed, airlines were the only businesses that I dealt with regularly that practiced "price discrimination," charging different customers different prices for the same seats. Economists broadly like this "second-order" price discrimination, where a company charges customers different prices based on the circumstances of the purchase, such as a bakery discounting bread at the end of the day. When an airline cranks up the price of an itinerary that doesn't include a Saturday stay, they're using that fact as a proxy for "price-insensitive" business travelers whose bosses can afford to...

10. Consequences of progress toward the Riemann Hypothesis

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 22:29:28 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/07/consequences-of-grh/>

The Riemann Hypothesis (RH) is the conjecture that all the zeros of the Riemann zeta function $\zeta(s)$ in the critical strip, i.e. the region of the complex plane with real part between 0 and 1, have real part equal to $\frac{1}{2}$. The Quasi Riemann Hypothesis (QRH) says that there exists a constant θ . The post Consequences of progress toward the Riemann Hypothesis first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Faster Fourier Transform

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 21:41:47 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/07/faster-fourier-transform/>

The Fast Fourier Transform (FFT) algorithm can compute the discrete Fourier transform of a sequence of length n in time $O(n \log n)$. OpenAI recently posted a paper saying there is an algorithm that could compute the discrete Fourier transform in $O(n (\log n)^{1+\epsilon})$ time for $\epsilon = 10^{-13}$. This result is amazing. It seemed that ϵ The post Faster Fourier Transform first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Irrationality exponent of π

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 21:19:20 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/07/irrationality-exponent-of-pi/>

For a real number x , the irrationality index $\omega(x)$ is a way of measuring how well x can be approximated by rational numbers. If x is rational, $\omega(x) = 1$. If x is irrational, $\omega(x) \geq 2$. OpenAI recently published a proof that $\omega(\pi) = 2$. Almost all real numbers have irrationality exponent 2, so the new result says $\omega(\pi) = 2$ The post Irrationality exponent of π first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. On Git Refs

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-10-07T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/10/07/git-ref.html>

I have recently improved my mental model of Git. Consider these two git commands:

14. Package Management RFCs

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-07T11:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/07/package-management-rfcs.html>

Package registries, manifest formats, lockfiles, version ranges and identifiers all have written specifications of some kind, spread across six kinds of venue. Specifications show up in package management mostly as an invisible layer of the dependency tree, where an HTTP library is built against RFC 9110 and a JSON parser against ECMA-404, and the documents covering package management itself are spread just as thinly. I went looking for the IETF's share, since wire protocols between independently written implementations are what the RFC series exists for, and found nine documents, most of them concerned with firmware updates on IoT devices. The rest is distributed among Ecma, ISO, CNCF and OASIS, the enhancement proposal processes individual ecosystems run for themselves, and for a couple of registries a service's own API reference. Which venue a document is published in determines whether a second client, a mirror or an archival reconstruction can rely on it, since each of those requires specified behaviour rather than whatever a given server returns this week. Venues Package management specifications are published in six kinds of venue: the IETF, the industry standards bodies,...

15. Monte-Carlo simulations

Source: Eli Bendersky's website | Published: 2026-10-07T19:34:00-07:00

Link: <https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/monte-carlo-simulations/>

Monte Carlo simulations (or methods) is the technique of applying randomness and the Law of large numbers to the solution of various scientific and engineering problems. One of its first documented uses was by Stanislaw Ulam and John von Neumann for nuclear weapon simulations after WWII [1]. In this post?

16. Shopify went back to native. I think the bigger shift is formal verification

Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/shopify-native-formal-verification/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed

Agents have collapsed the cost of building native apps twice. But I think they will also make formal verification the default way software gets written.

17. Anti-Patterns in Software Blogging

Source: Refactoring English | Published: Wed, 07 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://refactoringenglish.com/blog/anti-patterns-software-blogging/>

In software development, we collect anti-patterns to recognize common traits that lead to poor outcomes in our software. I thought it would be helpful to do the same for software blogging, so I've catalogued the most frequent mistakes I see from beginner bloggers. The meandering intro Preamble still counts as meandering? The reader knows everything I know except this one thing? Overreliance on links The sequel injection bug Excessive formality Fumbling on the basics of rendering HTML Page overflow on mobile Unreadable font Summary The meandering intro The most common mistake in software blogging, by far, is meandering. I constantly find myself several paragraphs into a post with no idea what the author is trying to tell me.